Read like a *detective.*

Six parts, a way into each one, and the traps the exam sets for you.

Six parts · 45 minutes · 32 questions

THE PAPER AT A GLANCE

No. 02

What’s on the paper

6

parts, from signs and notices to long articles

45

minutes for all of it

32

questions, one mark each

0

extra minutes to copy answers, so write them straight on the sheet

Wrong answers don’t lose marks. Never leave a gap.

Same idea, *different words.*

The text says “it costs nothing”, and the right answer says “it’s free”. If an option copies words from the text, get suspicious.

Why was this written?

1. What is it: a sign, a label, a text message, an ad?
2. Why does it exist? To warn you, sell you something, tell you off?
3. Say the message to yourself in your own words.
4. Find the option that means that, even if it uses different words.
5. Careful with options that say more than the text does.

Tiny words, big trouble

don't have to
you can if you want, it's not necessary

mustn't
don't. Really, don't.

might, may
maybe, nobody's sure

No parking
No + -ing means "not here"

PART 2 · 5 QUESTIONS · MATCHING

No. 05

Three things, one match

1. Each person wants three things. Underline them.
2. Look for those things in the texts. They'll be in other words.
3. The right text has all three. Not two. Three.
4. Underline where you found each one, so you can check.
5. Three texts won't match anyone. That's on purpose.

EXAMPLE

Lucía wants a course that is **cheap**, at the **weekend** and **outdoors**.

1 · cheap *2 · weekend* *3 · outdoors*

The text with two out of three is there to trick you.

PART 3 · 5 QUESTIONS · ONE LONG TEXT

No. 06

How does the writer feel?

1. Read the whole text once, quickly, before the questions.
2. Underline the key words in each question.
3. Find that part of the text. The questions go in order.
4. Answer in your head first, then look at A, B, C and D.
5. Can you say why the other three are wrong? If not, read again.

THE QUESTIONS ASK

How did the writer feel?

What does she think about…?

Why did he do this?

The last question is about the whole text, so you need the big picture.

PART 4 · 5 QUESTIONS · GAPPED TEXT

No. 07

Spot the links

1. Read the text with the gaps. What is each paragraph about?
2. Read the eight sentences.
3. Look at the sentence before the gap and the one after it.
4. Same topic? Same tense? Singular or plural?
5. Read it all again at the end. Three sentences are left over.

Words that point

this *that* *these* *it* *them* *one* *there*

Words that link

however *instead* *too* *another* *otherwise*

Which word fits?

1. Read the title and the whole text first.
2. Look at the word after the gap. It often decides the answer.
3. Try all four words in the gap. Say them in your head.
4. Pick the one that means the right thing and sounds right.
5. Read the text again with your answers in it.

Learn them in pairs

have a break

make a decision

take a photo

spend time

grow up

keen on

interested in

afraid of

depend on

find out

One word. Usually a small one.

1. Read the whole text first. Don’t fill anything in yet.
2. For each gap, ask: what kind of word is missing?
3. Read the words on both sides of the gap.
4. Write one word, and spell it correctly. It matters here.
5. Read your text. Does every sentence make sense now?

THE USUAL ANSWERS

who — *which*

where — *than*

the · a — *was · been*

in · on · at — *although*

Relative pronouns, articles, auxiliaries, prepositions, linkers.

MANAGING TIME

No. 10

How to spend your 45 minutes



Short tasks get about 6 minutes. Long texts get about 9. It’s a guide, not a law.

Stuck? Guess, put a mark next to it, and come back later.

Read the whole text first.

Good luck.